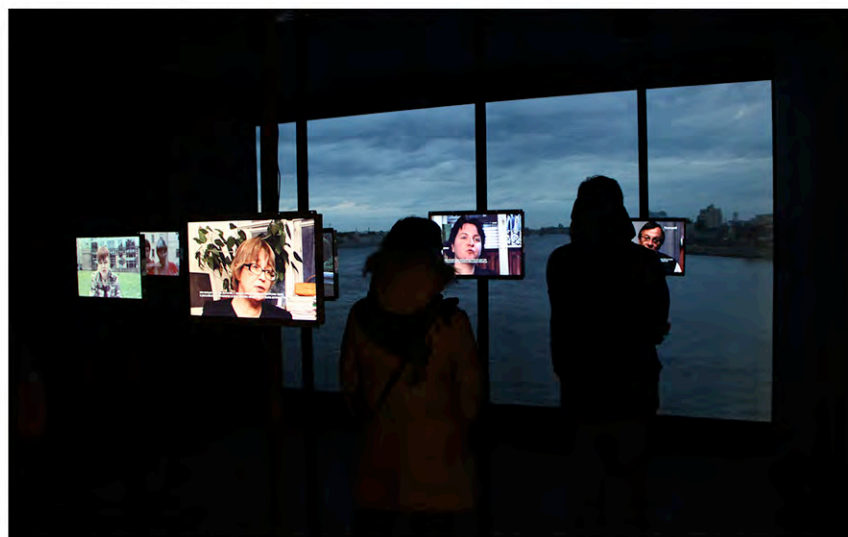


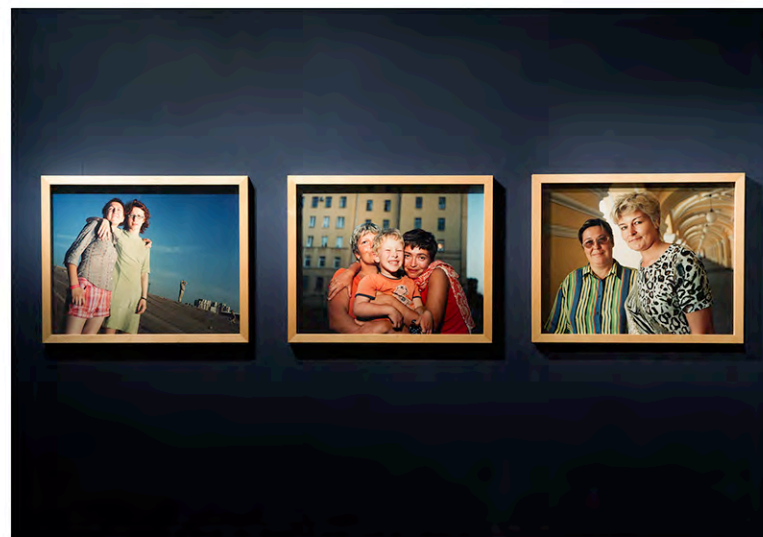
State of Mind



State of Mind in Gogolfest, Art Arsenal, Kiev 2009



State of Mind, Y - gallery for contemporary art, Minsk, 2010



Queer Lives in Russia, Museum of World Culture, Gothenburg, 2016



Lezzie Think Tank, Minsk, 2010

State of Mind

Karlsson Rixon and Hallberg

Media: eleven analogue photographs (4x5, type C photography), a video projection, seven 19" monitors with filmed interviews, seven metal rods and ambient soundscape. The installation varies according to the exhibition location and context.
Language: Russian and English
Year: 2006 - 2016

State of Mind is an extensive work based on interviews and portraits of queer communities in St. Petersburg, Russia, performed during the years 2006 - 2007. The work revolves around the living conditions of lesbian and bisexual women.

Visually and conceptually the installation is based on the smaller groupings of "friends and lovers" that form the core of the work. This is found in the photographic portraits as well as in the structure of the video installation. The work is designed to draw attention to the viewer's own positioning in relation to the people depicted and the active choices that must be made to gain a deeper understanding.

Exhibiting *State of Mind* was an ongoing process that involved connecting to each location's local queer groups and art milieu. We arranged the Lezzie Think Tank workshop during each exhibition, usually held with the installation as a backdrop and sometimes during opening hours if this was considered safe for the participants. This was done to create a local platform for discussion around LGBTQI issues, but also to spread information about the project and create contact between queer groups and the art scene. *State of Mind*'s underlying idea of the queer community was thus staged at each exhibition, and became part of the work.

State of Mind was made in collaboration with Anna Viola Hallberg. The work is also part of my artistic research dissertation *Queer Community through Photographic Acts* (2026), and is discussed in my thesis book with the same name.

The project *State of Mind* has been occurring in the contexts of art, activism and academy. The installation has been exhibited in Stockholm (2008 & 2010), St. Petersburg (2008 & 2012), Gothenburg (2008 & 2016), Kharkiv (2009), Kiev (2009), Minsk (2010), Salzburg (2011) and Berkeley, Ca (2011).

The installation *State of Mind* is part of the Gothenburg Museum of Art's collection since 2016.